
Subject: Information from Sugar Creek Presbyterian Church

From: Jane Jolly <mjolly937@gmail.com>

To: jimmy.wead@gmail.com

Date Sent: Thursday, March 26, 2026 6:05:08 PM GMT-05:00

Date Received: Thursday, March 26, 2026 6:05:26 PM GMT-05:00

Attachments: PXL_20260326_214008411.MP.jpg,PXL_20260326_213948477.MP.jpg,PXL_20260326_213102962.MP.jpg

Dear Mr. Wead,

Here are 2 pages from the book, "Our Creative Years" (picture of the cover attached as well) written in 1954 by the late William Bigger on the occasion of our 150th anniversary. There are possible relatives listed on both excerpts from his writing.

Jane Jolly

"Our Creative Years"

A History of the Sugar Creek United Presbyterian Church

Dayton, Ohio

1784-1954

William H. Bigger



The First Sugar Creek Church

*"By Thy favor we have been enabled to build
this house to Thy name, and for Thy glory."*

of the Gospel of Jesus Christ and also in consideration for the sum of fifteen dollars of lawful money of Ohio hath given, granted, bargained, sold, aliened, and confirmed and by these presents do give, grant, bargain, sell, alien, and confirm unto the said Thomas Bigger, Robert McClelland, Samuel D. Bradford, and Joseph Bigger, Trustees and their successors in office forever, all that tract or lot of land lying in the aforesaid County of Greene and being a part of the Northwest Quarter in Section No. 9 Twp. 2 in range No. 6 beginning at a stone on the South Boundary line of said quarter and 85 W 5 chains to a stone, thence N 3 chains to a stone, thence N 85 E 5 chains to a stone, thence S 3 chains to the beginning containing one acre and fifty hundredth of an acre together with all and singular hereditaments and appurtenances thereunto the right title interest claim or demand of the said Hugh Holmes and Mary his Wife either in law or equity of in or to the above granted premises with the said hereditaments and appurtenances to have and to hold the said premises above particularly mentioned and described to the said Thomas Bigger, Robert McClelland, Samuel D. Bradford, and Joseph Bigger, Trustees and their successors in office that the said Hugh Holmes are seized in fee of the aforesaid granted premises, that they are free from all incumbrances, that he hath good right to give, sell, and convey the same as aforesaid to the said Thomas Bigger, Robert McClelland, Samuel D. Bradford, and Joseph Bigger, Trustees, and their successors in office forever against all lawful demands of all persons whatsoever, in witness whereof the said Hugh Holmes and Mary his wife have hereunto set their hands and seals the day and year first above written . . . Signed Hugh Holmes, Mary Holmes. Vol. 14, Page 144." On 5 November 1869 this tract with the building was sold back to the Holmes (Samuel) family for One Hundred Seventy-five Dollars.

Under the date of August 28, 1836 the following entry appears which is of unusual interest and also gives a partial list of the members at that date: "Appointed Thursday next to be a day of fasting and humiliation in this congregation in view of the Lord's Supper to be dispensed in Xenia congregation on Sabbath the 4th of September and the duty of public covenanting to be engaged in on Monday following, the 5th of September." Then under date of September 1, 1836 is entered: "The following persons offered themselves as candidates to go forward in the duty of public covenanting, viz.:

Thomas Bigger	William Bain
John Tate	William Liggett
Ebenezer Andrew	Timothy Dodds
Jane Finley McClelland	Margaret McBeth
Mary Liggett	Gibson Wade
John Liggett, Jnr.	Mary Jane Watt
Mary Bain	George Dell
James Wat	Margaret Bigger
Elizabeth Barrett	James Riddle
Agnes McCandliss	Amelia Scott
Eliza Abercrombie	John Liggett
Sarah Wade	Joseph White
James Bigger	Martha McClelland
Mary Bigger, Snr.	Nancy Liggett
Mary Ann White	Dinot White
Mary Low	Thomas White
Robert McClelland	James W. Harper
Joseph Bigger	Mrs. Mary Liggett
Polina Andrew	Isabella Dodds
Mrs. Mary Liggett	Rebekah Abercrombie
Susanah Tate	John I. Wade
Henry Liggett	Meriah Crane

Page 22

Jane Dill
Stephen White
Nancy Low
Esther White
These persons being all members in full, and free from scandal and possessed of measurable knowledge of the nature and seasonableness of this duty were by session adjudged meet to go forward."

The following addition was made on the 5th of September:

"William Bigger	Margaret Wat
Elizabeth Wat	Andrew Wat
Jane Wat	Isabella Abercrombie
George Wat	James Dodds."
Nancy Abercrombie	

After a pastorate of eight years Mr. Templeton resigned in July 1838 and went to Granville, Putnam County, Illinois in November of 1839 until his death Dec. 3, 1843 from inflammation of the lungs. At this time the number of members reported was one hundred and sixty and the number of families fifty. During the following year a call was moderated and accepted by Rev. George Maxwell Hall. He was born Dec. 26, 1807 in Hebron, Washington County, New York, was graduated at Union in 1831, and studied theology at Canonsburg, was licensed July 8, 1835 by Chartiers Presbytery and ordained September 16, 1836 by Miami. Taken from Rev. W. J. McMichael's sermon of August 28th, 1904 we have the following information: "During Hall's pastorate the congregation passed through a peculiar and trying experience. Rev. Andrew Heron, pastor of the Caesar's Creek Congregation (Jamestown) having been found guilty of attending a week day service in the interest of some African Negroes, conducted by Rev. H. H. Blair who had been deposed by the Synod for adhering to the Bullions party, was suspended from the ministry for insubordination. He found a strong sympathizer in Mr. Hall and they, with the majority of their congregations, organized the Free Associate Presbytery of Miami. A number of the congregation still remained in the Associate Church. These called as their first pastor Rev. Cyrus Cummins, who was installed on October 23, 1846 and his pastorate continued until 1853. By this branch of the church Messrs. Ebenezer Andrew, J. Stewart Wade, and Nathan Thompson were elected to the eldership. The Free Associate Presbytery was soon dissolved and Mr. Hall returned to the fold of the Associate Synod. He soon demitted his charge and the congregation finally connected with the Associate Reformed Church under the supervision of the Presbytery of Springfield. Thus we had two denominations where one existed before, both occupying the same building. By arrangement the Associate Reformed Branch had the use of the building three-fourths of the time and the Associate one-fourth. In 1848 Rev. H. H. Johnston was installed as pastor over the Associate Reformed branch. He continued as pastor until 1851, and during this time Mr. Robert Bradford was added to the eldership. Mr. Johnston was succeeded by Rev. R. W. Henry who served as pastor two years. It was possibly a year or more after his release that Rev. R. E. Stewart was called. He was installed on Sept. 12, 1856 and it was during his pastorate that the memorable union of 1858 took place when the Associate and Associate Reformed Churches were united under the name of the United Presbyterian Church of North America. This served to unite the two branches of the Sugar Creek congregation and it again became one and so continued." As Rev. W. J. McMichael's father, the venerable Rev. J. B. McMichael thirty-four years before remarked, "all divisions have been happily healed, and ministers and members are now in the same ecclesiastical communion." Rev. Hall became pastor of Florida, Montgomery County, New York, September 5, 1849-62; of the 2nd church Boston, Mass., April 17, 1865-68; and Thompsonville, Conn., 1868-71 when he retired to Cambridge, N. Y. where he died in Dec. 27, 1874.

Cyrus Cummins was born July 10, 1812 in Kishacoquillas Valley, Mifflin County, Penna., was graduated at

Wash
was l
orda

Chill
stud
1841
lo"
St.
184

Alle
Col
lice
ord
pas
9,
join
wit
He
fe
th
th
Re

Turn Of The Century

This was the change of the century and also marked a century for the church in the State of Ohio. Many new names became associated with the church during the passing years. Many of them were familiar names of families already attending. Others were friends and neighbors of long standing in the community, and some were new families who had entered the Greene and Montgomery County area for the first time. Many of them were pioneers in their own right. The list of those who attended the old log meeting house north of Bellbrook is only known in part. The earliest members were those mentioned as participating in the migration and their children; and some of those members of families that Armstrong preached to during his original look at the area. Many were among those listed earlier in this account as offering themselves as candidates in the duty of public covenanting in September of 1836, as this action was taken only three years after the first entry in the Session Book entitled "New Meeting-House" dated August 27, 1833 which marked the official recording of the move from the log church at Bellbrook to the one on what is now the "Feed Wire Road." It is to be noted that this listing as well as those that follow are those people that joined the church. No effort has been made to list the removals due to the magnitude of searching the records.

William Stewart
Nancy Law
Mary Stewart
Fannie Wade
Gibson Wade
Ebenezer Wade
Elizabeth Wade
Mary Jane Wade
Margaret Wade
John Torrence
Jane Torrence
Aaron Torrence
John Torrence
David Torrence
Elizabeth Torrence
Morenda Torrence
John Gibson
George Bradford
Margaret Bradford
James McBride
Elizabeth Barrett
William McCampbell
Grace McCampbell
Mary Bigger Stevenson
Sarah Bigger VanEaton
J. J. Bradford
Paul Nutt
Mary Nutt
John Todd
Polly Todd
Mrs. Barr
John Low
Sarah Low
Amelia Dickensheet
Margaret Tate
David Baird
Mary Baird, & dau.
Mary Baird
George Gibson

John Bigger, Sr.
Mary Bigger
John Bigger, Jr.
Mary Bradford Bigger
Samuel Bradford
Mary Ann Bradford
Jane Dinwiddie
Isaiah McClelland
Elizabeth McClelland
Hannah Bigger Holmes
Mrs. Mary McConnell
Mrs. Mary Espy
Casandra Abercrombie
Alexander Goudy
Nancy Herrington
Jane Dodds
Alexander McCormack
Albert Phillips
Elizabeth Phillips
Rebekah Phillips
Margaret Bonner
William Andrew
Susannah Andrew
John Andrew
Nancy Andrew
William Davidson
Elizabeth Davidson
John Davidson
Mrs. John Davidson
Mrs. Ballantine
Joseph Saxton
Joseph Davidson
Margaret Davidson
J. Dunlap
Margaret Charters
J. Bradford Bigger
Jane Bigger
Abigail Bigger

William Bradford
Jemima Bradford
Sarah J. Holmes
Mary Jane McAudless
J. A. Andrew
Hannah Holmes
Elizabeth Holmes
John Bradford Bigger
Mary Bain
Polly Bain
Emily Bain
Martha Holmes
Andrew Holmes
William Bradford
Sarah J. Holmes
Rebecca Holmes
Samuel S. Dindiddie
John A. Dinwiddie
Amanda Holmes
Nancy Holmes
Mary Holmes
Harriet Holmes
Joseph F. Stevenson
John Bigger
Findley G. Hopkins
Amanda White
Mrs. Elizabeth Bigger
Joseph Stout*
Thomas Patrick, M.D.*
Mrs. Mary Patrick
Nancy Dodds
James W. McClure*
Mary Jane Miller*
Angeline Andrew
John Miller*
Mary Dallas
Ella Holmes
Anna M. Johnson
Margaret Lamb
Sarah Bradford
Joseph Holmes
Mathew Bigger
Eliza Jane Bull*
Fannie M. Bigger
James Dinwiddie*
Robert A. Andrew
Martha Bigger
Samuel Bigger
Mary Bradford
Eliza Wade
Jane Allen Bradford
Eleanor Bregor
Clarissa White
Eliza Allen
Sarah Holmes
James Holmes
Benjamin Horner*
Dr. J. Kyle & wife
James Andrew
Mary M. Holmes
Andrew K. Tate
Hannah J. White
Mary J. White
Mary E. White
Wm. R. Kable, M.D.
Margaret Bradford
Joseph White*
Margaret E. Bradford
Martha D. Bradford
Hugh Holmes
Robert Bradford

William Espy
Mary Andrew
Samantha Andrew
Frank Holmes
Mrs. D. Hart
Maggie McClure*
William Dodds
Lenise ? Strain*
Joseph Murphy*
Alexander Williamson
Othemle Morre*
Rachael Miller
Mary McLean
Nancy McAudless
James B. McBracken
Mary McCracken
Dinsmore Bigger
Samuel B. Bigger
Isabella Jane Bull*
Elizabeth Williamson
Hugh Patterson Stewart
Margaret Foster
Jeremiah Gest
Elizabeth Bonner
Stephen B. White
Rebecca Holmes
Sarah Ann Holmes
Jane Riddle
Mary Jane McClure
Elizabeth Dallas
John Bradford
Mary McClure*
Ralph Bennett*
Mary Bradford
Joseph Bigger
Mary Jane Williamson
Rebecca Williamson
William A. Hopkins
John McD. Hopkins
Hannah J. Holmes
John McClure
Mahala Dinwiddie*
John Dinwiddie*
James Stewart
Joseph Hamill Bigger
James Strain
Nancy Strain*
Thomas Bradford
Abigail Bradford*
Rachael V. Bradford
Sue Dinwiddie*
Lizzie McClure*
Josephus Loy
John Stephenson
Caroline Sruise?*
James Williamson
Louiza Miller*
Frederic Dirner
Mary Hopkins
Jane Bain
Hannah McCracken
John Holmes
Thomas Holmes
Elizabeth McAulis*
Amanda Dutro*
Joseph C. Williamson
Mary E. Williamson*
Susan Dodds
Mrs. Ann Whitesite
David Lennord?
Thomas Bigger

Following the move to "The Road to Xenia" (Feed Wire Road) the Session Book contains the following names covering a period of about forty years including those that were admitted to the "afternoon church" in Bellbrook. Asterisks denote baptisms, and all names are taken as they appear. Some have diversified spelling: